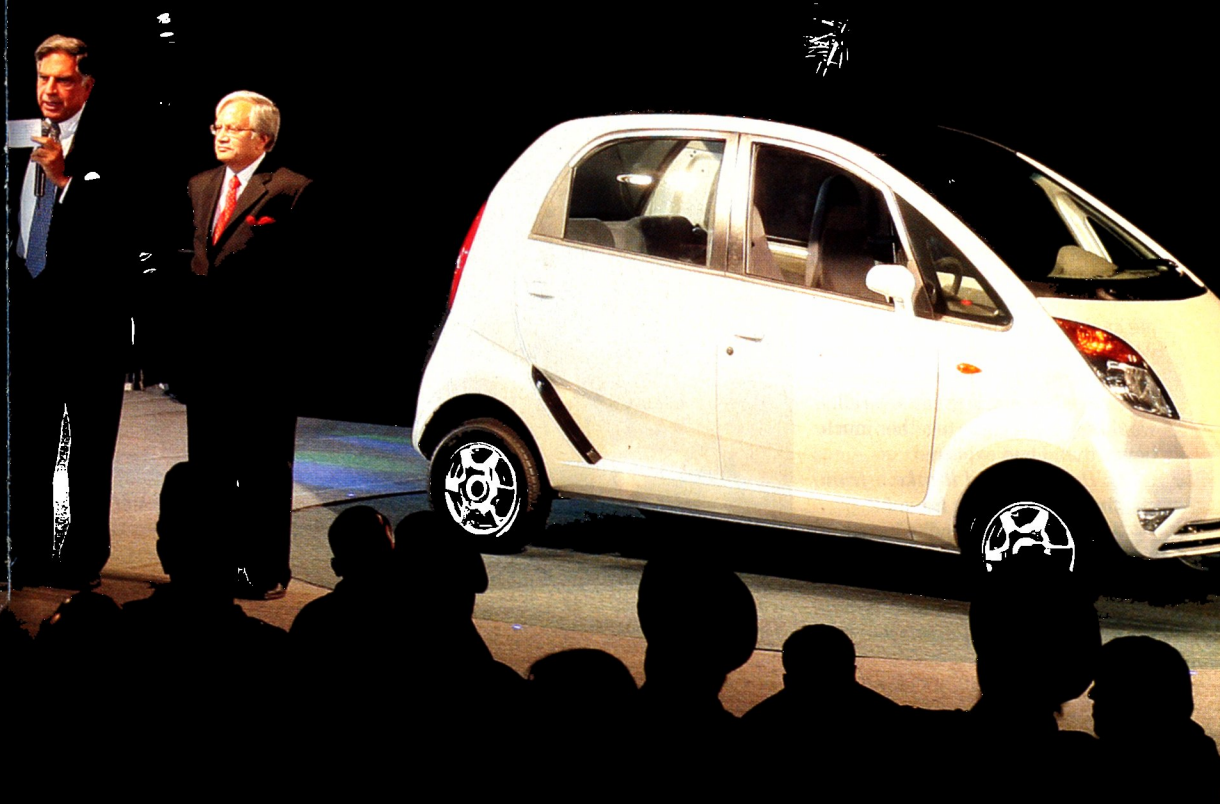


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TATA'S NANO IS A TESTIMONY TO INDIA'S ENGINEERING, DESIGNING AND FRUGAL MANUFACTURING SKILLS. PRICED AT RS 1 LAKH, IT PROMISES TO HERALD THE SECOND ROAD REVOLUTION SINCE THE LAUNCH OF THE MARUTI 800 IN THE 1980S.



them cut costs, along with a high-growth market with a scaleable potential. One doesn't have to rely solely on the market share occupied by Maruti. Currently, 80 lakh two-wheelers, 13 lakh cars and 6 lakh three-wheelers are sold in India every year. Add 5 lakh used car sales. Hypothetically, each of these buyers is a potential customer. At the price the Nano is being offered, there could be a new set of users—for instance, fuel-guzzling old taxis or unstable three-wheel rickshaws.

But it wasn't just the arithmetic of this proposition that prompted Tata to think about a people's car. Typically, the trigger was a social concern. On a wet August night in 2003 Mumbai, when Tata was driving back home from his

ROAD RAGE: Tata (centre) unveiling the Nano with his core design team office Bombay House in Flora Fountain, he saw a young couple travelling with their two children on a two-wheeler and was struck by the enormous risks of riding on a wet road.

The thought of a small car germinated in his mind and a week later, on a visit to the Tata Motors plant in Pune, he shared his thoughts with MD Ravi Kant. Instinctively, his first query was whether the two-wheeled scooter could be made safe. "The first doodles," in Tata's words, "were sketches of a two-wheeler with a bar around it and some weather-proofing."

Thereafter, a core team of 500 (including those in charge of setting up

TATA NANO

Engine: 624cc, 33 bhp
Fuel efficiency: Over 20 kmpl
Safety: Meets international norms
Emission: Euro 4 compliant
Gear box: 4-speed, manual
Fuel tank: 30 litre
Other features: Front disc brakes and drums in the rear
Top speed: 90 kmph
Space: 21 per cent more space than Maruti 800
Booking starts: September 2008

**Excluding taxes and transportation cost
On-road price is estimated to be RS 1.25 lakh*